

Lesson 1: Timing and Communication in No Trump Play

1 RACE TO ESTABLISH



establish
your tricks
BEFORE
the opponents

2 CHOOSE THE SOURCE OF TRICKS

ONE-ROUND SUIT

1



High card
takes the trick

TWO-ROUND SUIT

1



→

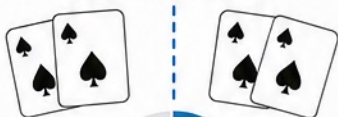


Play high, then
play again

3 IMPORTANT PERCENTAGES

3-3 SPLIT = 36%

(less than 1 in 3)



Less than
1 in 3

3-2 SPLIT = 68%

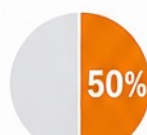
(2 in 3)



2 in 3

FINESSE = 50%

(1 in 2)



1 in 2

4 DANGEROUS OPPONENT



the defender
who must
NOT gain
the lead



5 DUCKING THE OPENING LEAD

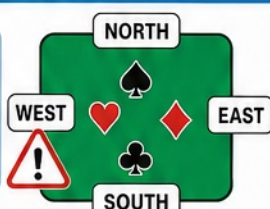


cut the
defenders'
communication



6 EXAMPLE

If West has
the long suit,
do NOT let
West gain
the lead!



7 DECISION TREE: "WHO IS DANGEROUS? HOW DO I AVOID THEM?"

**WHO IS
DANGEROUS?**

The defender
who can cash
their tricks
and lead again.



**CAN THEY GAIN
THE LEAD?**

YES

**HOW CAN I
AVOID THEM?**

GOOD!
Keep control.
Establish your tricks.



Duck the opening lead.



Play early in a suit.



Establish your tricks fast.



**Do NOT let the dangerous
opponent gain the lead!**